Unfertilized egg

- The female even not fertilized by male is capable of liberating eggs. These unfertilized eggs are narrower, longer and elliptical in shape.
- These are heaviest of all the helminthic eggs – It measures about 80µm × 105µm in size.
- The eggs have a thinner shell with an irregular coating of albumin (Figure 8.16).
- These eggs do not float in saturated solution of common salt.

HOTS

What makes worm's egg float or sink?

8.6.4 Life – Cycle

The life – cycle of *A. lumbricoides* is completed in a single host, human (Figure 8.17).

Infective form: Ermbryonated eggs. The fertilized egg passed in feces is not immediately infective. It has to undergo a period of development in soil. The development usually takes from 10–40 days. The embryo moults twice during the time and becomes the infective rhabditiform larva.

Mode of transmission: Man acquires the infection by ingestion of food, water or raw vegetables contaminated with embryonated eggs of the round worm.

The ingested eggs reach the duodenum to liberate the larvae by hatching. These

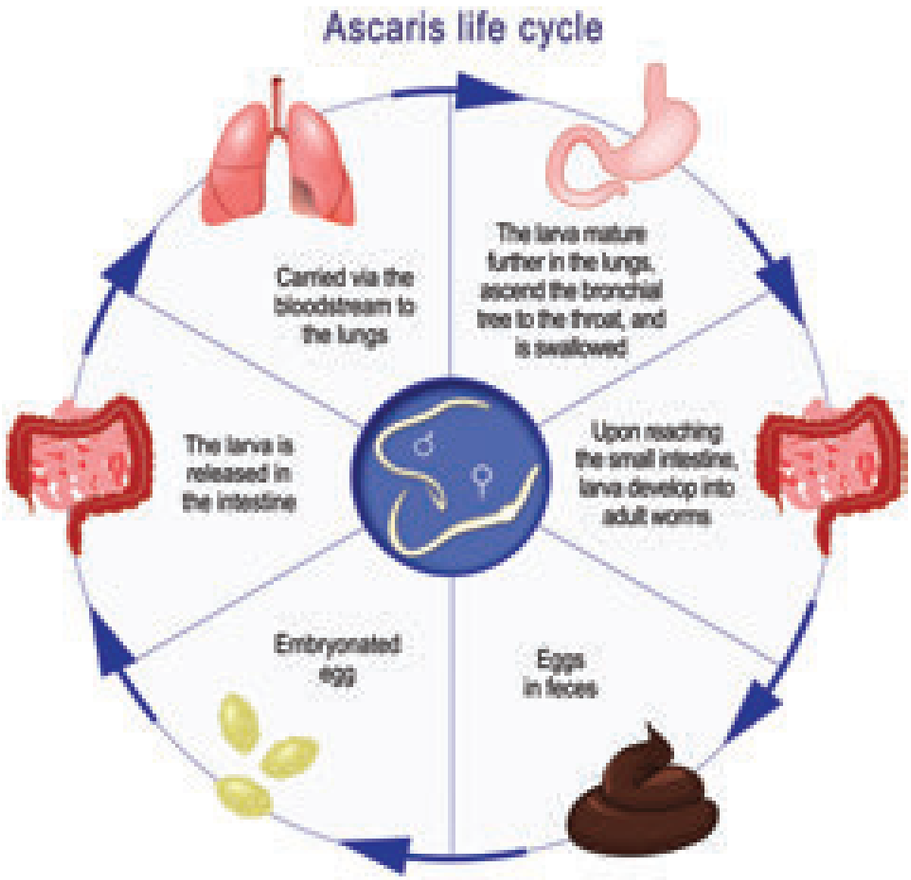


Figure 8.17: Lifecycle of *Ascaris lumbricoides*

TN_GOVT_XII_Micro_Biology_CH08.indd 182 27-02-2019 14:53:06